

78 Reflexive pronouns

Reflexive pronouns show that the subject of a verb is the same as its object. They can also be used in other situations to add emphasis.

See also:

Verbs patterns with objects 53

Personal pronouns 77

78.1 REFLEXIVE PRONOUNS

Reflexive pronouns in English are formed by adding the suffix “-self” or “-selves” to simple pronouns.

The subject pronoun refers to the person doing the action.

A reflexive pronoun is used when the same person is affected by the action.



He cut **himself** while chopping vegetables.

HOW TO FORM

OBJECT PRONOUNS

REFLEXIVE PRONOUNS

me → **myself**

you → **yourself**

This is the plural form of “yourself.”

you → **yourselves**

her → **herself**

him → **himself**

it → **itself**

us → **ourselves**

them → **themselves**

FURTHER EXAMPLES

I left **myself** a reminder about the meeting.



You must prepare **yourselves** for this exam.



Sarah sees **herself** as a natural team leader.



He introduced **himself** to the other guests.



The door locks **itself** when you close it.



We pride **ourselves** on our customer service.



They're teaching **themselves** to cook.

